

Power of Interest
Acceptable Information Technology Use Policy

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1. Introduction

Power of Interest UK (POI) uses information technology to support its charitable activities and deliver services effectively and securely.

This policy applies to all employees, volunteers, trustees, directors, contractors and any other individuals who have access to POI's information systems, email accounts, data or devices.

All users are expected to read, understand and comply with this policy and any associated policies, including:

- Data Protection Policy
- Privacy Notice
- Safeguarding Policy
- Social Media Policy
- Incident Reporting Policy

Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action and, where appropriate, legal action.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Protect POI's information and systems.
- Ensure compliance with data protection legislation.
- Promote responsible and secure use of technology.
- Minimise the risk of cyber security incidents and data breaches.
- Set out acceptable standards of conduct when using POI technology.

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- POI email accounts;
- Slack use and internal communications platforms used by POI
- Cloud-based services used by POI;
- Personal devices used for POI business;
- Documents and data created or stored on behalf of POI;
- Social media accounts operated by POI.

POI does not own or manage its own computer network or servers and primarily relies on third-party cloud providers for its information technology services.

4. Acceptable Use

Users must:

- Use POI systems primarily for legitimate organisational purposes.

- Act professionally and responsibly when using POI technology.
- Comply with all applicable laws and organisational policies.
- Protect confidential and personal information.

Users must not:

- Access information they are not authorised to view.
- Share passwords or login credentials.
- Install unauthorised software on organisational devices.
- Use POI systems to harass, discriminate against or abuse others.
- Download, create or distribute unlawful, offensive or inappropriate material.
- Use POI systems for personal commercial activities.
- Circumvent security controls.

5. Email and Internal Communication

5.1 Email Accounts

POI may provide official email accounts to staff, volunteers and directors where necessary.

Email accounts:

- Remain the property of POI.
- Must only be used for legitimate organisational purposes.
- May be monitored where necessary to protect the organisation and comply with legal obligations.

5.2 Security of Email Accounts

Users must:

- Keep passwords confidential.

- Use strong passwords.
- Enable multi-factor authentication where available.
- Report suspicious emails immediately.
- Exercise caution when opening links or attachments.

5.3 Slack and Internal Communication Platforms

Power of Interest (POI) uses Slack as its primary internal communication platform for staff, volunteers, trustees and other authorised users. Slack is used solely for legitimate organisational business and is not used to communicate with children or young people participating in POI activities.

Users of Slack must:

- use Slack only for authorised POI business;
- communicate professionally, respectfully and in accordance with the Staff and Volunteer Code of Conduct;
- use only POI-approved workspaces and channels;
- protect confidential and personal information in accordance with the Data Protection Policy;
- report any suspected security incident, unauthorised access or inappropriate use immediately;
- not share login credentials or permit others to access their account; and
- ensure organisational information is shared only with those who require it for legitimate purposes.

Access to Slack will be restricted to authorised users and removed promptly when an individual leaves the organisation or no longer requires access.

5.4 Personal Email Accounts

Personal email accounts should not be used for POI business unless expressly authorised by a Director. Where personal email must be used in exceptional circumstances, users must ensure that any personal data is handled securely and deleted when no longer required.

5.5 Leaving POI

When an individual leaves POI:

- Access to organisational accounts will be removed promptly.
- Email accounts may be retained or archived in accordance with POI's Data Retention Policy.

6. Passwords and Authentication

All users must:

- Use strong and unique passwords.
- Avoid reusing passwords across multiple services.
- Keep passwords confidential.
- Change passwords immediately if compromise is suspected.
- Use multi-factor authentication wherever possible.

Passwords must never be:

- Shared with others;

- Written down in an insecure location;
- Sent by email or instant message.

7. Information Security

7.1 General Responsibilities

Everyone using POI systems is responsible for protecting:

- Personal information;
- Confidential organisational information;
- Login credentials;
- Electronic documents and records.

7.2 Data Classification

Information should be handled according to its sensitivity:

Public - Information that can be shared publicly.

Internal - Information intended for use within POI.

Confidential- Information containing personal, financial or sensitive information.

Confidential information must be shared only with authorised individuals.

8. Use of Personal Devices (BYOD)

POI recognises that staff and volunteers may use personal devices for organisational activities.

Anyone using a personal device for POI work must:

- Protect the device with a password or PIN.
- Keep software and security updates installed.

- Use antivirus software where appropriate.
- Prevent unauthorised access to POI information.
- Log out of accounts when no longer required.

Sensitive information should not be stored on personal devices unless necessary.

9. Cloud Services and Storage

POI primarily uses cloud-based systems to store information.

Users must:

- Use only approved cloud services.
- Store information securely.
- Avoid unnecessary duplication of personal data.
- Delete information when it is no longer required.

Users must not upload POI information to unauthorised third-party services.

10. Internet and Social Media Use

Users must:

- Use the internet responsibly.
- Avoid websites that may compromise security.
- Ensure that social media activity does not damage POI's reputation.

Only authorised individuals may:

- Access official POI social media accounts.
- Publish statements on behalf of POI.

The Social Media Policy should be read alongside this policy.

11. Public Wi-Fi

Public Wi-Fi networks may present security risks.

When using public networks, users should:

- Avoid accessing highly sensitive information where possible.
- Log out of systems when finished.
- Ensure devices are not left unattended.

12. Loss of Devices and Security Incidents

Any of the following must be reported immediately to a Director:

- Lost or stolen devices containing POI information.
- Suspected hacking or phishing attempts.
- Accidental disclosure of information.
- Unauthorised access to accounts.
- Malware or ransomware incidents.

POI may take steps to secure organisational information, including requiring password changes or removing access to accounts.

13. Monitoring

To protect organisational information and comply with legal obligations, POI reserves the right to:

- Monitor the use of organisational email accounts;
- Investigate suspected misuse;

- Review access logs where available;
- Suspend access where security concerns arise.

Any monitoring will be proportionate and carried out in accordance with applicable data protection legislation.

14. Data Protection

All users must comply with:

- UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR);
- Data Protection Act 2018;
- POI's Data Protection Policy and Privacy Notice.

Personal data must:

- Be processed lawfully;
- Be kept secure;
- Only be retained for as long as necessary;
- Only be shared where authorised.

15. Breaches of this Policy

Failure to comply with this policy may result in:

- Removal of access to POI systems;
- Disciplinary action;
- Termination of volunteer or employment arrangements;
- Referral to law enforcement or regulatory authorities where appropriate.

16. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if:

- There are significant changes to legislation;
- New technology is introduced;
- A security incident indicates that changes are necessary.